

GHOST TOWN OF THE DESERT RAT
INTRO SEQUENCE

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1 EXT. SALOON - DAY

A cowboy rides up towards a saloon, hitches his horse and goes inside the saloon

2 INT. SALOON - DAY

Close up of the lips of a beautiful girl, a beauty mark above her lip

WOMENS VOICE

Howdy hot shot, what can I get ya?

BAR PATRON

Whiskey on the rocks

WOMENS VOICE

Single or double?

BAR PATRON

Two fingers doll

WOMENS VOICE

You got it hot shot

She pours him the drink and hands it to him, as he drinks he sees a photograph up on the wall of Whiskey Fox and Desert Rat

BAR PATRON

Whose that in that there picture?

She looks back, smiles.

WOMENS VOICE

Thats Whiskey Fox and the Desert Rat, famous outlaws in these parts

BAR PATRON

Never heard of 'em

WOMENS VOICE

Really? You've never heard the story about Whiskey Fox and the Desert Rat?

3 EXT. ALPINE BANK - DAY

Two horses are hitched outside of a bank, the camera is dollying away slowly

Pistol shots, shrill screams and indiscriminate burly shouts can be heard from inside the bank

A Fox runs out of the Bank with bags of cash

WHISKEY FOX

Lets go Rat!! Cash in the bag, lets go!

He gets on his horse and loops quickly

WHISKEY FOX (CONT'D)

RAT!!! COME ON, 'FORE THE SHERIFF RIDES UP!

4 INT. ALPINE BANK - DAY

Desert Rat has the women by her hair, pistol by her throat

DESERT RAT

Better not find out theres more cash 'ere or we'll be back 'fore the sunsets darlin', ya got that?

BANK TELLER

I swear, thats all we have.

DESERT RAT

You wouldn't lie to a rat like that would ya now?

5 EXT. ALPINE BANK - DAY

WHISKEY FOX

RAT! Sheriff's comin' over the hill we gotta go, come on!

6 INT. ALPINE BANK - DAY

DESERT RAT

Guess i'll take your word for it, but first.. your comin' with me!

Rat pulls her over the counter and outside into the street.

7

EXT. ALPINE BANK - DAY

WHISKEY FOX

What in tarnation, we said no
hostages Rat. Leave her we gotta
go!

Rat struggles to get both her and the cash onto the horse but
manages it

BANK TELLER

Please no! I have a daughter,
Please!! I gave you everything we
had!!

DESERT RAT

Need a darlin' to keep our cash
green n the sheriff red if you know
what i mean.

WHISKEY FOX

LETS GO!

They ride off moments before the sheriffs ride up

ALPINE SHERIFF

Y'all done did it this time Rat!

ALPINE DEPUTY

I got a clean shot!

ALPINE SHERIFF

Not while hes got Marcy with him
you don't!

Fox is focused, Rat is pleased. The Sheriff & Deputy are
right on their tail.

DESERT RAT

Aint this fun sweetie.

BANK TELLER

LET! ME! GO!

DESERT RAT

Suit yourself.

He goes and pushes her off

BANK TELLER

Ahhhh!

The Deputy catches her before she hits the ground by rushing in front of the Sheriff, forcing them to stop while the two bandits escape.

BANK TELLER (CONT'D)
You saved me, heavens me, my hero!!

She kisses him all over the face

ALPINE DEPUTY
Not a problem ma'am, wasn't gonna let a thing happen to somethin' as sweet as you

ALPINE SHERIFF
So much for the clean shot eh Deputy? Musta be the same duo from Marathon. Send a telegram right away when we get back.

The deputy nods

8 INT. SALOON - DAY

BAR PATRON
Woah, Alpine? Alpine's not too far from here. And Marathon? What happened in Marathon?

WOMENS VOICE
Oh, haven't you heard? Was all over the papers for weeks.

BAR PATRON
Can't say I read much miss, do sit in a lotta saloons tho

WOMENS VOICE
Well, the papers never officially said what was on it. But word has it, The Circus King John Ringling was hau--

BAR PATRON
CIRCUS KING JOHN RINGLING?!
Ringling brothers John Ringling?!

WOMENS VOICE
One and same darlin', word has it he had some real big, real sparkley gemstones on that train.

9 EXT. HILL NEAR TRAINTRACKS

Fox looks at his stop watch, shuts it closed, revealing two dogs fighting a rodent.

WHISKEY FOX (O.S.)
Right on time

A train puffing steam is far off in the distance coming towards the bandits

DESERT RAT
Always is

10 INT. TRAIN COCKPIT

CONDUCTOR 1
Gotta love these 'ere plains,
peaceful. Gods country, endless
skies.

CONDUCTOR 2
Bit dull if you ask me, I left New
Yahk for this?

CONDUCTOR 1
Could be worse.

11 EXT. HILL NEAR TRAINTRACKS

The train is close enough for our bandits to start their mission

DESERT RAT
Showtime, YAAH!

They ride off towards the tracks

12 EXT. TRAIN

WHISKEY FOX
Alrigh' Rat!!! Hop on, clear em out
and get right back, no blood!

DESERT RAT
Wouldnt dream of it

He licks his revolver with a snear and a laugh

DESERT RAT (CONT'D)
On 3!

DESERT RAT (CONT'D)

1

WHISKEY FOX

2

WHISKEY FOX & DESERT RAT

3!

Rat jumps from his horse to the side of the train, climbing up on top of the boxcar.

13 INT. TRAIN COCKPIT

One of the conductors sees Rat hopping up on the train.

CONDUCTOR 2

Looks like we got a varmit tryin' to hitch a ride.

CONDUCTOR 1

No rats on this rodeo, cowboy.

He grabs the tin can phone and talks to the guards in the rear

CONDUCTOR 1 (CONT'D)

Got one climbin' up on board,

14 INT. TRAIN VAULT CAR

CONDUCTOR 1 (V.O)

might be one of dem plains boys we been hearin' bout.

GUARD 1

How many?

CONDUCTOR 1 (V.O)

Two, one up on top, the other rode off.

GUARD 1

Got it

He checks the ammo in his gun, its fully loaded. gives the barrel a spin and locks it back into place

GUARD 2

Think its the Fox?

GUARD 1
He'd better hope not.

15 EXT. TRAIN ROOFTOP

The Rat's riding the rails like a bat outta hell.

DESERT RAT
Time to take these boys to church,
papa needs a new diamond grip.

He pulls out some dynamite and secures it in place.

camera from a distance away

The rat has moved back on the train car and *BOOM!* The dynamite goes off. Smoke covers the Rat.

16 INT. TRAIN VAULT CAR

GUARD 1
coughing what the hell,
dynamite?!

GUARD 2
Open the damn window, i cant see a
god damn thang.

As hes trying to open the window, the Rat dropped down into the train car and beats up Guard 2. Gunshots pierce thru the walls of the train and shatter the window

17 EXT. TRAIN VAULT CAR

HU to the window shattering, dynamite smoke pours out the car

18 EXT. NEAR TRAIN

Whiskey Fox has been keeping pace with the train.

WHISKEY FOX
We said no blood goddammit. YAHH!

Whiskey rides up towards the train

19 INT. TRAIN COCKPIT

The Conductor still speaks into the phone

CONDUCTOR 1
Aye buck! You alright back there.
What in tarnations is goin on?

20 INT. TRAIN VAULT CAR

CONDUCTOR 1 (CONT'D V.O)
Make sure they dont get into the
vault!

Rat picks up the dangling phone while he's speaking

DESERT RAT
Dont you worry up there, the vault
is safe with me

Desert Rat blows the brains out of the second guard and then
shoots the lock of the door inside the train car

21 INT. TRAIN VAULT CAR VAULT

Silhouetted by the door, Rat stands in front of a pedestal
with a chained up box. Rat grabs the box and heads back out
to the top of the train.

22 EXT. TRAIN ROOFTOP

Whiskey Fox rides up close to the train with both horses

WHISKEY FOX
Come on Rat! We gotta go, the
trains pulling into town soon.

DESERT RAT
Catch!

Rat throws the chained up box down towards Whiskey and he
catches the end of the chain. The case smacks into the ground
and drags behind him

Rat jumps off the train and onto his horse

DESERT RAT (CONT'D)
Those circus clowns wont know what
hit em. YAH!

The two ride off away from the train leaving a cloud of dust
in their wake.

23

INT. SALOON

The woman paws and plays with a beautiful diamond necklace dangling off her dainty neck.

WOMENS VOICE

That wasnt even the crown jewels of
heists they pulled

BAR PATRON

Theres more?!

WOMENS VOICE

Darn tootin'. Now look, this where
it gets complicated. There was this
big gov'ment movement of gold from
Mexico that was headed right up to
Washington thru Terlingua. the
Terlingua Gold Rush they called it,
woulda been the biggest prize yet
for those boys, but ya know, theres
a reason why call him Rat. And it
aint cause his good looks.

BAR PATRON

Was he workin with the feds?

WOMENS VOICE

Cant say for sure.

BAR PATRON

So whatdya mean? Did he give up the
Fox?

The only other patron in the bar speaks up

MAN IN THE BAR

Worse

He gets up with his empty drink and walks over to the bar

MAN IN THE BAR (CONT'D)

Another miss.

She winks and tops his mug

WHISKEY FOX

Betrayal.

TITLE CARD